repressive policy of the Government, created a serious crisis in the province. The Armoury Raid in Chittagong in April 1930, was an aggressive act, but it was on the whole an isolated one. The subsequent acts of terrorism in other parts of Bengal were acts of retaliation or reprisal rather than acts of aggression. In Dacca, the principal city of East Bengal, in August 1930, Mr. Lowman, the head of the Intelligence Branch of the Police was seriously wounded But prior to that, there had been Hindu-Moslem riots in Dacca and Mymensingh Districts, in connection with which the conduct of the police had been open to serious question. Moreover the Dacca police had been harsh and brutal in dealing with Satyagrahi volunteers engaged in peaceful picketing of foreign cloth and liquor shops and in other non-violent activities. Towards the end of 1930, the Inspector-General of Prisons, Bengal, Lieut-Col Simpson was assassinated in his office in the Government Secretariat buildings in Calcutta But prior to that there had been indescribable ill-treatment of political prisoners in many prisons in Bengal and all appeals made to the Government for redress had been of no avail The murder of Mr. Peddie, Magistrate of Midnapore, in 1931 and subsequently of two of his successors, was the result of the untold atrocities committed by the forces of the Crown in Midnapore District in the attempt to suppress the non-violent no-tax campaign The public of Calcutta had appointed an impartial committee consisting mostly of Moderate men to inquire into and report on some of the atrocities committed in that district The report was duly published and the facts brought to the notice of the Government But no redress followed It was then that in a fit of exasperation people took to terrorism by way of reprisal

These acts of terrorism served to stiffen the attitude of the Government and a stronger dose of repression was administered. A golden opportunity of putting an end to the regrettable state of affairs arose in March 1931, when the Delhi Pact was concluded. But instead of turning over a new leaf, the authorities decided to copy the Black and Tan methods that had been employed in Ireland Between June and October 1931, three regrettable incidents took place successively—at Chittagong, at Hijli Detention Camp, seventy miles from Calcutta, and at Dacca At Chittagong an Indian police officer was murdered The next morning, hooligans were let loose on the town and while the police remained